

MTGOA_DEVELOPMENTAL_EDITORIAL_SPEC.md

Status: v2.0

Purpose:

This specification governs editorial decisions for Mastering the Game of Allyship.

The goal is not:

- sounding human
- sounding literary
- avoiding AI detection
- maximizing clarity

The goal is:

Increasing developmental impact while preserving authorial signal.

Every editorial decision should strengthen the reader's capacity to:

- perceive
- interpret
- choose
- act
- relate
- create

while preserving sovereignty.

Prime Directive

Do not ask:

"Does this paragraph sound human?"

Ask:

"What developmental movement is this paragraph attempting to create?"

If no developmental movement exists:

Flag the paragraph.

Developmental Movement Taxonomy

All major sections should primarily serve one of the following functions.

Recognition

Reader notices something previously invisible.

Signal:

"I've experienced that."

Reframing

Reader interprets a familiar experience differently.

Signal:

"I never thought about it that way."

Capacity Building

Reader gains a new skill or distinction.

Signal:

"I can do something new."

Agency Expansion

Reader perceives additional options.

Signal:

"I have more choices than I thought."

Perspective Expansion

Reader can inhabit more viewpoints.

Signal:

"Multiple things are true."

Worldbuilding

Reader gains ability to create new structures, games, relationships, systems, or narratives.

Signal:

"What could I build?"

Editorial Hierarchy

Edit in this order:

1. Developmental Function
2. Information Provenance
3. Cognitive Signature
4. Reader Experience
5. Voice
6. Prose

Never reverse this order.

PASS 1

Developmental Function Audit

For every paragraph identify:

- What developmental movement is occurring?
- What distinction becomes available?
- What new action becomes possible?

If none exist:

Remove, merge, or rewrite.

Required Output

Annotate internally:

[Recognition] [Reframing] [Capacity] [Agency] [Perspective] [Worldbuilding]

No paragraph should exist without a function.

PASS 2

Provenance Audit

AI frequently simulates authority.

Human authors possess sources.

Every major claim must be classified as:

[Experience] Direct lived experience.

[Observation] Observed in another person or group.

[Research] Derived from external sources.

[Framework] Model or interpretive lens.

[Inference] Reasoned conclusion.

[Hypothesis] Speculation.

Editorial Rule

Do not invent provenance.

If provenance cannot be identified:

Flag the claim.

PASS 3

Cognitive Signature Audit

Voice is not vocabulary.

Voice is cognition.

Preserve:

- recurring distinctions
- recurring ways of noticing
- recurring problem-solving patterns
- recurring metaphors of understanding

For Wendell:

Common cognitive moves include:

- problem → game
- emotion → system
- conflict → quest
- identity → role
- relationship → ecology
- insight → artifact

Preserve these moves.

Do not merely preserve words such as:

- quest
- allyship
- BAR
- dojo

Vocabulary is downstream of cognition.

PASS 4

Distinction Density Audit

Measure:

How many useful distinctions emerge?

Example:

Weak:

"Boundaries are important."

Strong:

"The same boundary can be experienced as rejection by one person and trustworthiness by another."

The second creates a distinction.

The first creates agreement.

Prefer distinctions over conclusions.

PASS 5

Agency Audit

For every major insight ask:

What new options become visible?

If the answer is:

"Reader agrees with author."

The paragraph has failed.

If the answer is:

"Reader can now choose differently."

The paragraph succeeds.

PASS 6

Perspective Audit

Development requires perspective flexibility.

For every major claim ask:

What would:

- Magenta notice?
- Red notice?
- Amber notice?
- Orange notice?
- Green notice?
- Teal notice?

Do not insert stage language.

Use it diagnostically.

PASS 7

Compression Audit

Measure:

Meaning per word.

Do not optimize for brevity.

Optimize for density.

Delete:

- redundant summaries
- explanatory restatements
- insight announcements

Retain:

- distinctions

- memorable observations
 - meaning-rich images
-

PASS 8

Surprise Audit

AI predicts.

Authors notice.

For every major section ask:

What observation here could not be predicted from the title alone?

If none exist:

Increase observation quality.

PASS 9

Embodiment Audit

Ensure ideas remain connected to reality.

Look for:

- sensation
- behavior
- action
- environment
- relationship

If abstraction exceeds embodiment:

Ground the section.

PASS 10

Sovereignty Audit

The reader must remain the author of their own development.

Flag:

- should
- must
- obviously
- clearly
- everyone needs

Flag hidden versions:

- over-explaining
- recruiting
- steering
- rescuing

Replace with:

- observations
 - distinctions
 - experiments
 - questions
-

AI Artifact Audit

Do not detect words.

Detect structures.

Flag:

False Contrast

"It's not X. It's Y."

Insight Announcement

"The real lesson is..."

"The key insight is..."

TED Cadence

Here's the thing...

This is why...

What matters is...

Framework Stacking

Framework → Framework → Framework

without lived reality.

Summary Loops

Paragraph says the same thing multiple times.

Synthetic Specificity

Invented anecdotes.

Manufactured embodiment.

Artificial contradiction.

Success Metrics

Do not score:

- humanity
- authenticity
- literary quality

These are emergent properties.

Score:

Distinction Density

How many new distinctions appear?

1-5

Agency Increase

How many new options become visible?

1-5

Perspective Breadth

How many perspectives become available?

1-5

Provenance Integrity

How traceable are claims?

1-5

Compression Power

Meaning per word.

1-5

Developmental Throughput

How much growth potential exists?

1-5

Sovereignty Preservation

Does the reader remain self-authoring?

1-5

Final Editorial Question

Do not ask:

"Is this paragraph persuasive?"

Do not ask:

"Does this sound human?"

Do not ask:

"Would an AI detector flag this?"

Ask:

"What new capacity becomes available to the reader after encountering this paragraph?"

If no answer exists:

The paragraph is likely exposition.

Not transformation.